

Received about 12 15 PM in reply to mine.

My Dear Sir & Mrs
Belmont

The intention is to
advance the day: if the
Army has the desired effect
of driving the enemy off
or having other effect such
as to warrant us in making
the attack. When that moment
arrives advise Gen P.
and of course advance
such artillery as you can
use in aiding the attack.
With respect

Yours faithfully
Cecil

Gen Pickett at 1 40 PM

The 18 guns have been driven off
For gods sake come on quick or we
cannot support you Ammunition nearly out

Respy yours

Wm. H. H. H.

Colony.

Reply about 12 30

Monday July 3 1863

At Longstreet's house

General.

When our artillery
fire is at its best I
will advise Gen Pickett to
advance

Respy yours

Wm. H. H. H.

To Gen Pickett at 1 25 PM

July 3 1863

General.

If you are to ad-
vance at all you must
come at once or we will
not be able to support you
as we ought, but the
enemy's fire has not
slackened materially &
there are still about
18 guns firing from the
cemetery.

Respy yours

Wm. H. H. H.

Colony.

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THE BLUE AND THE GREY.

LEE'S SURRENDER.

HIS ACCOUNT OF THE MOVEMENT AROUND
APPOMATTOX COURT HOUSE.

[Reminiscences by Rev. J. W. Jones.]

The following letter has been made public for the first time in Mr. Jones' Reminiscences of the late war:

NEAR APPOMATTOX COURT HOUSE, VA.,
April 12, 1865.

His Excellency Jefferson Davis—Mr. President: It is with pain that I announce to your Excellency the surrender of the Army of Northern Virginia. The operations which preceded this result will be reported in full. I will therefore only state that upon arriving at Amelia Court House on the morning of the 4th with the advance of the army, on the rear from the lines in front of Richmond and Petersburg, and not finding the supplies ordered to be placed there, nearly twenty-four hours were lost in endeavoring to collect in the country subsistence for men and horses. This delay was fatal and could not be retrieved. The troops, wearied by continued fighting and marching for several days and nights, obtaining neither rest nor refreshment, and on moving on the 5th, on the Richmond and Danville Railroad, I found at Jetersville the enemy's cavalry, and learned the approach of his infantry and the general advance of his army toward Burkeville. This deprived us of the use of the railroad, and rendered it impracticable to procure from Danville the supplies ordered to meet us at points of our march. Nothing could be obtained from the adjacent country. Our route to the Roanoke was therefore changed, and the march directed upon Farmville, where supplies were ordered from Lynchburg. The change of route threw the troops over the road pursued by the artillery and wagon trains west of the railroad, which impeded our advance and embarrassed our movements.

On the morning of the 6th General Longstreet's corps reached Rice's Station, on the Lynchburg Railroad. It was followed by the commands of Generals R. H. Anderson, Ewell and Gordon, with orders to close upon it as fast as the progress of the trains would permit, or as they would be directed, on roads further west. Gen. Anderson, commanding Pickett's and B. R. Johnson's divisions, became disconnected with Mahone's division, forming the rear of Longstreet. The enemy's cavalry penetrated the line of march through the intervals thus left, and attacked the wagon train moving toward Farmville. This caused serious delay in the march of the centre and rear of the column, and enabled the enemy to mass upon their flank. After successive attacks, Anderson's or Ewell's corps were captured or driven from their position. The latter general, with both of his division commanders, Kershaw and Custis Lee, and his brigadiers, were taken prisoners.

Gordon, who all the morning, aided by Gen. W. F. Lee's cavalry, had checked the advance of the enemy on the road

from Amelia Springs, and protected the trains, became exposed to his combined assaults, which he bravely resisted and twice repulsed; but the cavalry having been withdrawn to another part of the line of march, and the enemy pressing heavily on his front and both flanks, rendered the attack about 6 p. m., and drove him from the field in much confusion. The army continued its march during the night, and every effort was made to reorganize the divisions, which had been shattered by the day's operations; but, the men being depressed by fatigue and hunger, many threw away their arms while others followed the wagon trains and embarrassed their progress. On the morning of the 7th rations were issued to the troops as they passed Farmville, but the safety of the trains requiring their removal upon the approach of the enemy, all could not be supplied.

The army, reduced to two corps, under Longstreet and Gordon, moved steadily on the road to Appomattox Court-house; hence the march was ordered by Campbell Court-house, through Pittsylvania toward Danville. The roads were wretched and the progress slow. By great effort the head of the column reached Appomattox Court-house on the evening of the 8th, and the troops were halted for rest. The march was ordered to be resumed at 1 a. m. on the 9th. Fitz Lee with the cavalry, supported by Gordon, was ordered to drive the enemy from his front, wheel to the left and cover the passage of the trains, while Longstreet, who from Rice's station, had formed the rear guard, should come up and hold the position. Two battalions of artillery and the ammunition wagons were directed to follow the army; the rest of the artillery and wagons to move toward Lynchburg. In the early part of the night the enemy attacked Walker's artillery train near Appomattox station, on the Lynchburg Railroad, and were repulsed.

Shortly afterwards their cavalry dashed toward the Court-house till halted by our line. During the night there were indications of a large force massing on our left and front. Fitz Lee was ordered to ascertain its strength, and to suspend his advance till daylight if necessary. About 5 a. m., on the 9th, with Gordon on his left, he moved forward and opened the way. A heavy force of the enemy was discovered opposite Gordon's right, which moving in the direction of Appomattox Court-house, drove back the left of the cavalry and threatened to cut off Gordon from Longstreet, his cavalry at the same time threatening to envelop his left flank. Gordon withdrew across the Appomattox River, and the cavalry advanced on the Lynchburg road and became separated from the army. Learning the condition of affairs on the lines where I had gone, under the expectation of meeting Gen. Grant, to learn definitely the terms he proposed in a communication received from him on the 8th, in the event of the surrender of the army, I required a suspension of hostilities until these terms could be arranged. In the interview which occurred with Gen. Grant, in compliance with my request, terms having been agreed on, I surrendered that portion of

the Army of Northern Virginia which was on the field, with its arms, artillery, and wagon trains, the officers and men to be paroled, retaining their side-arms and private effects.

I deemed this course the best under all the circumstances by which we were surrounded. On the morning of the 9th, according to the reports of the ordnance officers, there were 7,892 organized infantry with arms, with an average of 75 rounds of ammunition per man. The artillery, though reduced to 63 pieces, with 93 rounds of ammunition, was sufficient. These comprised all the supplies

of ordnance that could be relied on in the State of Virginia. I have no accurate report of the cavalry, but believe it did not exceed 2,400 effective men. The enemy was more than five times our number. If we could have forced our way one day longer, it would have been at a great sacrifice of life, and at its end I did not see how a surrender could have been avoided. We had no subsistence for men or horses, and it could not be gathered in the country. The supplies ordered to Pamplin's station from Lynchburg could not reach me, and the men, deprived of food and sleep for many days, were worn out and exhausted.

With great respect, your obedient servant,
R. E. LEE, General.

*Gettysburg Apr 29th 93
When Longstreet & Gordon were Pickett's Div - passed
us on the charge upon Cemetery Hill.*